

C-Span Interview

Jasmine Crockett is an American politician currently serving on the US House of Representatives for Texas's 30th congressional district. Upon her election in 2023, she was interviewed by C-Span to learn more about her background and political motivations. In the interview, Crockett discusses her law career, an early experience with racism, and what led her to running for office. Link to the interview: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iAH4oqyGmVw>

The interviewer asks a variety of open and closed questions that all help draw out Crockett's story. Some are open questions, like "Was there something or someone in your early years that triggered your interest in civil rights?" or "Did your predecessor give you any advice?" Two questions were about Crockett's law career and asked how long she practiced for, as well as what her law career taught her about herself and how it prepared her for coming to Congress. These probing questions allowed Crockett to elaborate on her career, which helps establish her credibility and qualifications to the audience. Then, to help transition between discussing Crockett's law career to her new tenure in congress, the interviewer used a nudging probe by saying, "And it sounds like that's why you're here today." This signaled to Crockett to talk about her motivations for running for Congress and the changes that she wanted to make and see.

I would say that all of the interviewer's questions were effective, mostly because Crockett was a willing and enthusiastic interviewee who had a lot to share. Even if a question was closed, such as "Did your predecessor give you any advice?", Crockett answered beyond a simple yes or no. There was a good amount of trust and respect between the interviewer and Crockett for her to share so much information about her career and ambitions. The most effective questions, i.e., the ones that drew out the most information, were the reflective and open-ended questions. For example, how Crockett's law career prepared her for Congress, and if there was

something in her early years that triggered her interest in civil rights. The answers to these questions tend to have more of a narrative or personal story behind them, which conveys information better than just stating it plainly. At the end of the interview, the interviewer's final question is more on the fun side, in which she asks Crockett for her favorite song and to perhaps sing a bit of it. Crockett politely declines to sing, but she maintains interdependence of the interview to answer the question of her favorite song. This final question is so the audience can see that Crockett is just another human being like us, who enjoys listening to music and singing.

If I were interviewing Jasmine Crockett, I would host a sort of retrospective interview where we rewatch this interview today and have her current self reflect on her past self's answers. After three years in Congress under changing leadership and shifting geopolitical landscapes, I am sure Crockett has a much different perspective than her freshman Congress self. The purpose of this interview would be to hear her perspective on her past self and how that differs from her current state of mind. I would start the interview by greeting her and thanking her for her time, as she is probably extremely busy as a Congresswoman. Then, I would ask her if she recalled the interview she did for C-Span when she first entered Congress three years ago. I would invite her to rewatch it together, and afterwards I would ask her the main interview questions.

In my interview, the three general topic areas I want to cover are: 1) Her retrospective on her past interview, 2) Her current work in Congress, and 3) The state of Texas and her constituents. I think it would be interesting to get Crockett's opinion on her past interview because she has undoubtedly changed since first coming to Congress. Especially with the current state of the country and the world, she has most likely faced trials and tribulations within the government. Since she has actually experienced being a Congresswoman by now, I would ask

her how she thinks her law background prepared her for this role, and how she applied the advice that her predecessor gave her. Perhaps she even has a different favorite song than before. Overall, it would be interesting to compare her previous, fresh-faced answers to her current, more experienced ones today. The other two topics are related to Crockett's current career in Congress, and they seem standard to discuss since being a Congressperson is not only an important and demanding role, but one that seems shrouded in bureaucracy and semantics to the average American. By sitting Crockett down and discussing her work in plain language, viewers and her constituents can feel more connected to her. I also specifically wanted to discuss the third topic, the state of Texas and her constituents, since in her C-Span interview, Crockett strongly emphasized helping people who couldn't help themselves and also enhancing the political reputation of Texas. I would aim to ask questions that dig into how Texas is doing politically and what she has been doing to contribute to that.

Interview Questions:

- 1) Her retrospective on her past interview
 - a) Primary: Did you expect the answers that your younger self gave?
 - i) Probing: How did those answers make you feel?
- 2) Her current work in Congress
 - a) Primary: What is a challenge that you didn't expect to face in Congress?
 - i) Probing: How did you overcome it, if at all?
- 3) The state of Texas and her constituents
 - a) Primary: What do you think of Texas's current role in politics?
 - i) Probing: How can ordinary Texans help bring change to that role?